

(13) Syncellus refers to Nabonadius as the last Neo-Babylonian king. He identifies Baltasar with Nireglesarus. Cyrus is mentioned as the next king of Babylon.⁵⁵

2. Attempts at Harmonizing Non-Cuneiform Data concerning Nabonidus and Belshazzar

Before the discovery and decipherment of cuneiform documents mentioning Nabonidus and Belshazzar scholars endeavored to explain the above non-cuneiform references to them in various ways, the general tendency being to leave undisturbed the position of Nabonidus as the last Neo-Babylonian king. Hence it was natural that divergence of critical theory should arise from attempts to provide a suitable historical rôle for Belshazzar. The following suppositions have been advanced:

(1) The name Belshazzar was a pure invention on the part of the writer of the fifth chapter of Daniel.⁵⁶

(2) Belshazzar was Evil-Merodach (*Amêl-Marduk*), and hence a son of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁷

(3) Belshazzar was a brother of Evil-Merodach, and hence a son of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁸

(4) Belshazzar was a son of Evil-Merodach, and hence a grandson of Nebuchadrezzar.⁵⁹

⁵⁵ See notes 34 and 35.

⁵⁶ This view was advanced before the discovery of the name *Bêl-šar-ušur* in cuneiform literature. See commentaries on Daniel by Von Lengerke, p. 204, and Hitzig, p. 75.

⁵⁷ This identification is supported by Zöckler in his commentary on Daniel, p. 34, Schaff's *Critical, Doctrinal and Homiletical Commentary*, XIII, where he enumerates a number of authorities in its favor, of whom Kranichfeld, Marsham, Niebuhr, Oehler, Röckerath and Zündel may be mentioned.

⁵⁸ See Sulpitius Severus, *Hist.* II, p. 6. Cf. Schoene, *Eusebii Chronicorum Libri Duo*, p. 95, for the following statement made by Eusebius: *Mortuo Nabochodonosor Babyloniorum rege suscepit imperium Euilmarodach cui successit frater eius Balthasar sub quo Daniel eam scribituram quae in pariete apparuerat interpretatus est significantem imperium Chaldaeorum in Medos et Persas transferendum.*

⁵⁹ See Quatremère in *Annales de la philosophie chrétienne*, (*Dict. de la Bible* II, p. 30, note), as quoted by Prince in *Mene, Mene, Tekel, Upharsin*. Quatremère advanced his hypothesis as an interpretation of Jeremiah 27: 7. Cf. Annii Viterbensis in *Antiquitatum Variarum Volumina XVII*, published in 1498, as quoted in *TSBA* I, p. 247 and p. 262, for the following list of Neo-Babylonian kings: *Nabugdonosor, annis 45; Amilinus Evilmerodach, annis 30; Filius hujus primus Ragassar, annis 3; Secundus Lab-Assardoch,*